

**New PS5!**

Sony may soon bring a new PS5 model, featuring a detachable disc drive.
<https://digit.in/oct22-43>

**No more FB login**

Nintendo has announced that it will be ending support for logins with Twitter and Facebook. <https://digit.in/oct22-44>

Sony WH-1000XM5

A cut above the rest

Revered by many, Sony's WH-1000X series has rarely disappointed with its class-leading Active Noise Cancellation and reliable sound. The winning formula by Sony continues with the latest and greatest noise cancelling headphones from the company – the Sony WH-1000XM5. The question remains, does the Sony WH-1000XM5 completely justify its increased cost or does it fall short? Let's find out.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Sony hasn't applied the "if it ain't broke, don't fix it" strategy this time around with the Sony WH-1000XM5. But, the flagship headphones from Sony get a complete design overhaul this year. The headphone's profile is slimmer, smoother, and curvier than its predecessor. The headphone has fewer visible joints and hinges and more discreet microphones. The whole look is more "stealthy", for the lack of a better word. Much like the Bose NC 700, the Sony WH-1000XM5 simply lie flat but don't fold away into a more portable unit, which can be a polarising design for some. That aside, the headphones are primarily built out of plastic but it feels exquisite and premium to the touch. Also, Sony's dedication to the environment impresses us – the WH-1000XM5 is made predominantly of recycled ABS. The headband now has sliders instead of clicking extenders. This feels sturdier than earlier designs and the extending process is now more seamless. Onboard controls remain largely the same. Quick Attention makes a comeback, so you can rest your palm on the right ear cup to instantly jump into Ambient Mode. The headphones house a USB-C charging port on the right cup and a 3.5 mm audio jack on the left cup for passive listening.

FEATURES

If you're willing to part with ₹34,990



of your hard-earned money, you would expect a cutting-edge pair of headphones with almost every modern-day feature at your disposal. And the Sony WH-1000XM5 delivers just that for you.

These headphones are chock full of premium features including ANC, an accompanying app, fast charging, and more. To help with delivering the best noise cancellation possible, the Sony WH-1000XM5 leverages the integrated V1 processor and upped the number of microphones from four to a whopping eight. Another one of Sony's best features is the excellent Headphones Connect app. You can tweak Adaptive Sound Control settings within the app. Sony's DSEE Extreme engine makes a comeback as well which allegedly upscales compressed music to near hi-res quality. The Sony WH-1000XM5 support your device's native assistant but they also come with Alexa built-in, which is great.

PERFORMANCE

Sony chose to go with a smaller 30 mm driver this time around compared to the 40 mm one that sat inside the

Sony WH-1000XM4. While flac files sound stellar with these headphones, DSEE Extreme can even eke out extra detail when you're streaming music over Bluetooth on Spotify or YouTube Music. In tracks such as Uptown Funk by Bruno Mars, the bass kick is rich and punchy but it can slightly impact the clarity of the mids. Mids, by themselves, are delivered with unerring precision and the headphones have impeccable timing as well. There's a slight peak in the highs that allows more clarity to come through but this doesn't sound tinny, thankfully. The headphones reproduce sound with lavish detail, something that's only hindered a tiny bit by the slightly boosted bass and low mids.



BUILD	81
FEATURES	91
PERFORMANCE	82
VALUE	75

BATTERY LIFE

The battery life of the Sony WH-1000XM5 remains largely unchanged from its predecessor. It lasted a little over 30 hours with NC turned on and AAC codec active. If you keep LDAC on, you may see the numbers drop. If your cans run out of juice, the Sony WH-1000XM5

comes with fast charging capabilities where just 3 minutes of charge can get you a whopping 3 hours of playback.

VERDICT

Sony has done it yet again! Expectations are always soaring when it comes to Sony's flagship WH-1000X series of headphones and the Sony WH-1000XM5 more than just meets it. The Sony WH-1000XM5 are, without a doubt, best-in-class noise cancelling headphones.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

BATTERY LIFE (MUSIC): Max. 30 hrs (NC ON), Max. 40 hrs (NC OFF) | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.2 | RANGE: 33 ft | SUPPORTED AUDIO FORMAT(S): SBC, AAC, LDAC | DRIVER UNIT: 118 inches / 30mm | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20 Hz-20,000 Hz (44.1 kHz Sampling) 20 Hz-40,000 Hz (LDAC 96 kHz Sampling 990 kbps) | HEADPHONE TYPE: Closed, dynamic

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